Hong Kong Exchanges and Clearing Limited and The Stock Exchange of Hong Kong Limited take no responsibility for the contents of this announcement, make no representation as to its accuracy or completeness and expressly disclaim any liability whatsoever for any loss howsoever arising from or in reliance upon the whole or any part of the contents of this announcement.

ASCENTAGE PHARMA GROUP INTERNATIONAL

亞盛醫藥集團

(Incorporated in the Cayman Islands with limited liability)

(Stock Code: 6855)

Voluntary Announcement

Ascentage Pharma Announces a New Drug Application for Its Novel Bcl-2 Inhibitor Lisaftoclax Accepted and Recommended Priority Review Designation by CDE of China's NMPA

Ascentage Pharma Group International (the "**Company**" or "**Ascentage Pharma**") is pleased to announce that a New Drug Application (NDA) for its in-house developed investigational novel Bcl-2 selective inhibitor, lisaftoclax (APG-2575), for the treatment of patients with relapsed or refractory (r/r) chronic lymphocytic leukemia/small lymphocytic lymphoma (CLL/SLL) has been accepted and recommended the Priority Review designation by the Center for Drug Evaluation (CDE) of China's National Medical Products Administration (NMPA). This NDA, the first for a domestically developed Bcl-2 inhibitor in China, could potentially lead lisaftoclax to become the second Bcl-2 inhibitor approved anywhere in the world.

This NDA is based on results from a pivotal registrational Phase II study in China (APG2575CC201) that evaluated the efficacy and safety of lisaftoclax in patients with r/r CLL/SLL. The primary endpoint of the study is the overall response rate (ORR).

CLL/SLL is a hematologic malignancy caused by mature B-cell neoplasms. It primarily affects older populations and is among the most common leukemia subtypes in the western world, with over 100,000 new diagnoses reported globally each year[1]. In China, where the incidence rate of CLL/SLL is lower than that of the western countries, the disease is occurring at a rapidly rising rate, with a younger age of onset and higher aggressiveness[2]. SLL and CLL are two different manifestations of the same disease and approximately 20% of all SLL cases would progress to CLL[3]. Treatments such as immunotherapies and Bruton's tyrosine kinase inhibitors (BTKis) have significantly improved patients' responses to initial treatment. However, due to the limitations of existing treatment options, the poor prognosis of patients, severe impact on patients' quality of life and high complexity of the disease, patients with r/r CLL/SLL are in desperate need for new treatment options that are safe and effective.

The introduction of Bcl-2 inhibitors has further revolutionized the treatment of CLL/SLL. Bcl-2 is an apoptosis suppressor factor that regulates cell survival by controlling mitochondrial membrane permeability. It suppresses apoptosis by inhibiting the release of cytochrome C from mitochondria or by binding to apoptotic activators to inhibit the activity of caspase. The overexpression of Bcl-2, found in a variety of hematologic malignancies, particularly CLL/SLL, is a key mechanism by which tumor cells evade apoptosis.

However, the development of Bcl-2 as a therapeutic target is challenging mainly because its mechanism of action is based on the protein-protein interaction (PPI). The binding interface of Bcl-2 is relatively large, making it difficult for small-molecule inhibitors to exert blocking effects. Additionally, the Bcl-2 protein is located on the mitochondrial membrane, and mitochondria, with its double-membrane structure, is among the most complex and challenging cellular components. Drugs must first penetrate the cell membrane before they can further act on the mitochondrial membrane. In nearly 40 years since the discovery of this target, only one Bcl-2 inhibitor has been approved globally, a reality highlighting the immense difficulty and challenges in this field of research and development. In western countries, the treatment of CLL/SLL has entered a new era of chemotherapy-free and fixed-duration regimens, while no Bcl-2 inhibitor has been approved in China in this therapeutic area. Therefore, patients in China have an urgent unmet need for such novel therapies.

Lisaftoclax is a novel, investigational orally administered small-molecule Bcl-2 selective inhibitor being developed by Ascentage Pharma to treat patients with malignancies by selectively blocking the antiapoptotic protein Bcl-2 and hence restoring the normal apoptosis process in cancer cells. Lisaftoclax is the first Bcl-2 inhibitor in China and the second anywhere globally that has demonstrated compelling clinical benefit and entered a pivotal registrational study. Lisaftoclax has broad therapeutic potential for a variety of hematologic malignancies and solid tumors, particularly as a single agent and in combinations in CLL/SLL. Lisaftoclax is a potential drug that may offer patients a safe, effective, and easy to use treatment option.

Lisaftoclax is being evaluated in multiple registrational Phase III studies, including a global registrational Phase III study of lisaftoclax in combination with a BTKi in previously treated patients with CLL/SLL (cleared by the US FDA); a global registrational Phase III study of lisaftoclax in combination with acalabrutinib for the first-line treatment of treatment-naïve patients with CLL/SLL; a global registrational Phase III study of lisaftoclax in combination with azacitidine (AZA) for the first-line treatment of elderly/unfit treatment-naïve patients with acute myeloid leukemia (AML) who were intolerant of standard induction chemotherapies; and a global registrational Phase III study of lisaftoclax in combination with AZA for the first-line treatment of newly-diagnosed patients with higher-risk myelodysplastic syndrome (MDS).

Cautionary Statement required by Rule 18A.05 of the Rules Governing the Listing of Securities on The Stock Exchange of Hong Kong Limited: We cannot guarantee that we will be able to obtain further approval for, or ultimately market, APG-2575 successfully.

By order of the Board
Ascentage Pharma Group International
Dr. Yang Dajun
Chairman and Executive Director

Suzhou, People's Republic of China, November 17, 2024

As at the date of this announcement, the Board of Directors of the Company comprises Dr. Yang Dajun as Chairman and executive Director, Dr. Wang Shaomeng and Dr. Lu Simon Dazhong as non-executive Directors, and Mr. Ye Changqing, Mr. Ren Wei and Dr. David Sidransky as independent non-executive Directors.

References:

1. Yao, Y., Lin, X., Li, F., et al. The global burden and attributable risk factors of chronic lymphocytic leukemia in 204 countries and territories from 1990 to 2019: analysis based on the global burden of disease study 2019. Biomed Eng Online. 2022 Jan 11;21(1):4. DOI: 10.1186/s12938-021-00973-6

2. Liu Peng. Practice guidelines for the diagnosis and treatment of chronic lymphocytic leukemia/small lymphocytic lymphoma in Zhongshan Hospital, Fudan University (v1.2018). [J]. Chin J Clin Med, 2018, 25(1): 157-160. DOI 10.12015/j. issn. 1008-6358. 2018. 20180

3. Li Jianyong, Qiu Lugui. Hematology Committee of Chinese Medical Association; Hematological Oncology Committee of China Anti-Cancer Association; Chinese Working Group for Chronic Lymphocytic Leukemia. The guidelines for diagnosis and treatment of chronic lymphocytic leukemia/small lymphocytic lymphoma in China (2022). Zhonghua Xue Ye Xue Za Zhi. 2022 May 14;43(5):353-358. DOI: 10.3760/cma. j.issn.0253-2727.2022.05.001